

Exercise 5: Dashboards and Story Points

A dashboard, a three-point story, and two captions. No memo.

Item	Details
Points	100
Data	Exercise 5 starter workbook, or clean/mvu_student_dim.csv
Reading	Learning Tableau 2025 (Milligan, 6th ed.), free through UTD Libraries: Ch 7, Ch 8 and Ch 11
Walkthrough	Module 5 of the MVU Tableau Walkthrough follows these same steps, with checkpoints.
Submit	One packaged workbook (.twbx) with the dashboard, the story and two visible captions. No memo, and no device layouts required.

Build the three views

The starter workbook already contains these sheets. If you have it, check the numbers and move on.

1. Headcount by College: college on Rows; student_id as Count (Distinct) on Columns; sorted descending.
2. Graduation Rate by Cohort: cohort_year (Discrete) on Columns; is_graduated as Average on Rows; default format Percentage, 1 decimal.
3. Withdrawal by Intensity: enrollment_intensity on Rows; is_withdrawn as Average on Columns, formatted as a percentage.

Checkpoint: Distinct students in the College of Science & Engineering?

Deliverable 1: the dashboard

1. New dashboard, Fixed size, Desktop Browser (1000 × 800).
2. Build the frame first: a Vertical container, with a Horizontal container inside its top half. Headcount and Withdrawal go side by side in the horizontal container; Graduation Rate goes below.
3. Distribute contents evenly and set Outer Padding to 4 on each view.
4. Add a filter action: source Headcount by College; targets the other two; run on Select; clearing shows all values.

Checkpoint: With College of Business selected, what does the headcount read?

5. Take things away: legends that repeat an axis, unneeded gridlines, titles that restate the obvious, extra decimals. Add a Text object at the top stating the question the dashboard answers.

Deliverable 2: the story

1. New Story. Story point 1: the dashboard, with a caption stating your headline finding.
2. Story point 2: the dashboard again with a filter applied (part-time only, or a single cohort). Caption what changed and why it matters.
3. Story point 3: end with what you would recommend someone actually do.

4. Check every caption: is anything claimed that the data doesn't support? Add one sentence naming a limitation.

Your two captions

Each worksheet carries a caption: a few sentences answering its question, written while the view is in front of you. Turn it on with Worksheet > Show Caption, then double-click below the view to edit.

Where	What your caption must answer
Dashboard	What did you leave out of the dashboard, and why?
Story	What might a reader wrongly conclude from your story, and what would you say to prevent it?

Story-point captions state findings, not chart labels. "Graduation rate by cohort" labels a chart; "Part-time students withdraw at three times the full-time rate" states a finding.

Before you submit: open each sheet and confirm the caption is showing. A caption toggled off still holds your text but won't be visible when your instructor opens the workbook.

Submit for Exercise 5

- Deliverable 1: a dashboard built with layout containers, consistent padding, and a working filter action
- Deliverable 2: a three-point story with captions that state findings rather than label charts
- A caption naming what you left out of the dashboard and why
- A caption naming what a reader might wrongly conclude from your story
- Packaged workbook (.twbx). No memo, and no device layouts required.